

1924, January 25

The following is a faithful transcription of the handwritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

January 25, 1924

Our Lady of Angels Monastery, Harlem, N.Y.
Very Rev. Pater Benno, O.M. Cap. Prov.
Calvary, Wisconsin

Very Rev. Dear Father Provincial:

You will have been naturally more or less anxious about Brother Pasqual, if we may still speak of him as such, instead of George Gordon. It would hardly be in place for me to take special interest in his case, but he seems to have a sort of confidence in me that, sorry to say he does not show to others who would be able to do more for him. I am sure a few minor details in this regard will not be unwelcome, and possibly will be of use - - -

I can not say just how, but I got the impression shortly before B. P. came here from Garrison and went to Hospital, that he was not very practical - or it was while he was in the hospital. Nevertheless I visited him twice during his stay there as a patient. I regretted that no one else (that I know of) visited him from here. More still I regretted the reception given him at his return to the Monastery. It seemed to me as an assurance that he was not welcome or wanted. I tried to excuse it. I do not know if I succeeded or not. I heard the words told him as he was starting upstairs: "You can stay here of course, but this is no hospital - -" About half an hour afterwards he came down, saying he was going to St. Vincent's Hospital to get a thorough examination. Not knowing the circumstances, and thinking that was the order of some one at St. Francis, I asked him no questions except if he would be back tonight. I believe he said he would go over to Pitt St. That was Sunday afternoon. Tuesday morning he came to the office - sine barba - doubting what to think of the manner of treatment here and at Pitt St. etc. Fr. Guardian was out when he came, whom he did not seem to want to see, and I told him he should by all means go over and see Father Definitior in East N.Y. and that I would try and phone over in the meantime.

Fr. Guardian came in before B. P. left and I told him he was there, and that I had determined him to go to Fr. Martin. Then I proposed - when Br. was gone - that I phone in his name and tell them something of the situation etc. I was simply forbidden to do so.

That was the last I heard about the case till two days ago when I received the enclosed letter. Fr. Paul was here last evening and talking about Br. I told them of this letter. This morning I said holy Mass up in the Assisium and afterwards returning I went of two blocks west to the Hotel Theresa and had a short talk with Br. He had been sleeping till I phoned up.